

A note to the Good Law Project — a draft, kept in the open

Like everything in this project, the letter is public before it is sent: github.com/GlassOnTin/civic-kernel.
Direct contact details travel with the sent copy, not the repo.

You don't know me; you do know the cases. Over the past months I have taken four matters the Good Law Project fought and rebuilt each one as a machine-checked case file: the documented events, then a step-by-step walkthrough asking one narrow question — *which record, required at which moment, citing which rule, would have changed this?* — with the answer validated against two small public data formats and an honest verdict at the end. Your litigation is cited in each file, alongside the judgments, audit reports and inquiry findings.

The four, with their verdicts:

- **The PPE VIP lane** (*GLP & EveryDoctor v Secretary of State for Health*) — every award logs the power it acts under and the referral that produced it, so a privileged lane becomes a signed, contemporaneous, countable number instead of a two-year reconstruction. Verdict: **strains** — legibility, not remedy; the aftermath of your own win, where nothing was cancelled and nothing came back, is the limit, and the file says so.
- **Government by WhatsApp** (the deletion case, with Foxglove) — verdict: **breaks**, and honestly: a message destroyed before any record exists defeats any log. What survives the analysis is the duty to record at the moment of decision — the tamper-proof log only matters once something reaches it.
- **COVID contract publication / FOI** (*R (GLP) v SSHSC; Cabinet Office v Information Commissioner & GLP*) — a record public by default has nothing to request, so there is nothing to slow-walk: deadlines, extensions and requester profiling all act on the request, and the request is gone. Verdict: **strains** — true for the acts it logs, not the reasoning kept off it.
- **The sewage scandal** (Environment Agency and Ofwat inaction) — every decision *not* to act is logged as a disposition citing its reason, so forbearance becomes countable where an unlogged non-decision leaves nothing to appeal. Verdict: **strains** — the record cannot compel enforcement; it makes the not-prosecuting a number.

One more thing, which may matter more to lawyers than the four above: a fifth case of yours was **refused**. The child-surname Article 8 matter asks for a judgment of substance — a child's best interests, who is right — and the protocol declines all such questions by design; the recorded reason says it plainly: *this belongs to a court, and the protocol has no business weighing it*. The method has said no to a sympathetic case and written down why; I'd rather you learned that from me than discovered it.

The four files sit inside a corpus that has since grown to sixty-one cases against 168 cited precedents, with verdicts of 52 *strains*, 8 *breaks*, 1 *holds* — it counts its own failures. If any of it is useful to you it is yours: the public telling is [findings.html](#) (with a section for advocates), the full argument is [map.html](#), and each case file is linked from [scenarios.html](#).

And the door, which is the real reason to write: cases are chosen by a [triage that shows its working](#). If a matter you are fighting now has the shape these share — a record quietly absent, quietly altered, or quietly ignored — propose it, and the triage will answer in the open: github.com/GlassOnTin/civic-kernel/issues.

Nothing here is commercial and nothing is asked of you beyond a look.

[Sender: name and contact line added on sending.]